

Overnight French Toast

For the french toast:

1/4 cup (1/2 stick) butter, room temperature

12 3/4-inch-thick French bread slices

6 eggs

1 1/2 cups milk

1/4 cup sugar

2 tablespoons maple syrup

1 teaspoon vanilla

1/2 teaspoon salt

Powdered sugar

For the maple syrup:

2 cups maple syrup

1 cup chopped walnuts, toasted

To make the french toast:

Spread butter over bottom of heavy large baking pan with 1-inch-high sides. Arrange bread slices in pan. Beat eggs, milk, sugar, syrup, vanilla and salt to blend in large bowl. Pour mixture over bread. Turn bread slices to coat. Cover with plastic and refrigerate overnight.

Preheat oven to 450°F. Bake French bread 10 minutes. Turn bread over and continue baking until just golden, about 4 minutes longer. Transfer cooked toast to plates and sprinkle with powdered sugar. Serve immediately, passing Maple-Walnut Syrup separately.

To prepare maple syrup:

Combine syrup and walnuts in heavy medium saucepan. Bring to simmer. Serve syrup hot. Makes about 3 cups.

Makes 6 servings